Accessible Politics Canada

By the Hackerz (like the movie)

The Problem

It is difficult for the average person to access and understand the steady flow of bills and legal documents that come out of the Senate and House of Commons. Those who would like to participate politically often won't because of the friction present in the process.

The Problem

Awareness

Legal Jargon

Being Informed on the Topic

Contacting Representatives

Awareness

Once the electoral polls close most people become entirely unaware of the political events of their country. If you don't know what is happening, how can you respond to it?

Legal Jargon

Even if someone hears about a bill, they won't be able to understand what a bill actually proposes outside of its title. Bills are unreadable to the average person.

Being Informed on the Topic

Beyond being able to read a bill, many people do not know enough about a political issue to form a confident position on a bill. Without intensive research on personal time, there's few ways to learn.

Contacting A Representative

While it isn't especially difficult to find your MPs contact information and email them, many people won't go through the effort to do it especially when it's likely that the MP will never see it.

The Solution - Key Elements

Summarization

Our open source project will provide the text of the bill alongside a (to be implemented) unbiased summary of the bill's contents and its ramifications.

One Click Email

Given the user's location data, the project will have the capability to send the users local MP a template email on their approval or disapproval of the bill, that can be edited before sending.

The Solution - Future Features

Dictionary Popups

Clicking on jargon terms will provide a popup with a definition.

Outsourced Summary

Summarization will be outsourced to vetted volunteer writers.

Location to MP to Email

A functionality that takes the users location, gets their districts MP and gets their email

Activist Group Summary

Since bias is inherently impossible to eliminate, give various activist groups input

Legal History

An extended list containing information on bills proposed in the last 30 years

Additional Search Capability

Expanded search and filter features to allow users to find specific bills

Who is this for?

Generally…

Everyone! We want to make politics easier for anyone who wants to be involved.

Specifically…

This project is geared towards those individuals who would like to partake in political discourse but are either too busy or jaded to engage on their own.

Thank You!